RUSSIA – UKRAINE – INDIA
TRADE INTELLIGENCE REPORT

Power BI Dashboard Analysis | FY 2019-20 to 2024-25

RU Russia	IN India	UA Ukraine
Crude Oil · Gas · Fertilizers	Pharma · Engineering · IT	Wheat · Sunflower Oil · Corn

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1. Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive analysis of bilateral trade flows between India, Russia, and Ukraine spanning six fiscal years from 2019-20 to 2024-25. The data, sourced from the Power BI Trade Intelligence Dashboard, captures 216 monthly trade records across three commodity categories — Energy, Agriculture, and Industrial — and three distinct geopolitical phases: Pre-War, Active War, and Prolonged War.

The Russia-Ukraine conflict, which escalated in February 2022, created a seismic shift in India's import strategy. India's dependence on Russian crude oil surged dramatically as Western sanctions pushed discounted Russian energy toward Asian markets. Simultaneously, Ukraine's agricultural exports to India collapsed, triggering food commodity price shocks globally.

1.1 Key Findings at a Glance

Total Records	Import from Russia	Import from Ukraine	Avg Profit % (India)
216	**$1,75,311.8 Mn**	**$21,689.3 Mn**	**14.23%**
6 Fiscal Years	*Dominant Energy flows*	*Collapsed post-war*	*Across all phases*

Export to Russia	Export to Ukraine	Total Trade Volume	Trade Balance
$70,713.8 Mn	**$20,763.1 Mn**	**$92,400 Mn**	**($1,05,524 Mn)**
Pharma & Engineering	*Declining post-war*	*India combined exports*	*Persistent deficit*

The data unequivocally demonstrates that India's trade balance with Russia and Ukraine is in a persistent deficit — driven overwhelmingly by massive crude oil and energy imports from Russia. The trade deficit widened sharply from FY 2022-23 as Russian energy imports surged, while Indian exports grew at a far slower pace.

2. Trade Overview — Page 1 Dashboard Analysis

The Trade Overview page of the Power BI dashboard provides a macro-level view of India's bilateral trade with both Russia and Ukraine. Four primary visualizations — the import trend line chart, commodity share donut, trade balance bar chart, and war phase grouped bar — collectively tell the story of how India's trade posture shifted across geopolitical phases.

2.1 Import Trend: Russia vs Ukraine

The line chart tracking monthly import volumes across all six fiscal years reveals three distinct phases of trade behaviour:

- Pre-War Phase (2019-20 to 2021-22): Russia and Ukraine imports were relatively stable. Russian imports averaged $300–700 Mn/month in energy, while Ukrainian imports were significant at $200–350 Mn/month in wheat and agricultural commodities.
- Active War Phase (2022-23 to 2023-24): Russian imports spiked dramatically — particularly in the Energy commodity category — as India capitalised on heavily discounted Russian crude oil. Ukraine imports simultaneously collapsed due to port blockades and supply chain disruption.
- Prolonged War Phase (2024-25): Russian imports reached peak levels, exceeding $4,000 Mn/month in the Energy category. Ukraine imports fell to near-negligible levels of $5–50 Mn/month.

2.2 Import Share by Commodity Category

The donut chart from the dashboard reveals the following commodity-level import distribution:

Commodity	Import Share %	Total Import (USD Mn)	Primary Products	War Phase Trend
Agriculture	47.62%	$82,600+	Wheat, Corn, Sunflower Oil	Collapsed in Active War
Industrial	27.98%	$48,500+	Steel, Aluminum, Titanium	Stable, slight rise
Energy	24.39%	$42,300+	Crude Oil, LNG, Natural Gas	Explosive growth

Agriculture commands the largest import share, primarily reflecting India's historical dependence on Ukrainian wheat and edible oils. However, the Energy category tells the more dramatic war-period story: while its overall share appears lower, Energy imports from Russia grew by over 400% in value during the Active War phase alone.

2.3 Trade Balance by Fiscal Year

The bar chart on the dashboard shows that India maintained a trade deficit across all six fiscal years, with the deficit deepening significantly from 2022-23:

Fiscal Year	War Phase	Trade Balance (USD Mn)	Balance Direction	Key Driver
2019-20	Pre-War	Moderate deficit	Deficit	Agricultural imports high
2020-21	Pre-War	Moderate deficit	Deficit	COVID impact on trade

Fiscal Year	War Phase	Trade Balance (USD Mn)	Balance Direction	Key Driver
2021-22	Pre-War	Moderate deficit	Deficit	Pre-war price escalation
2022-23	Active War	Large deficit	Deficit	Russian oil import surge
2023-24	Active War	Large deficit	Deficit	Continued oil dependency
2024-25	Prolonged War	Largest deficit	Deficit	Peak import volumes

The dashboard's total Trade Balance figure of ($1,05,524.2) Mn confirms that India's combined import bill from Russia and Ukraine far exceeds its export revenue, resulting in a cumulative trade deficit exceeding $1 trillion (Mn) across the study period.

3. Economic Impact — Page 2 Dashboard Analysis

The Economic Impact page of the dashboard focuses on macroeconomic indicators that contextualise the trade data — global commodity prices, currency exchange rates, and sanctions severity scores. These variables directly influenced India's cost of imports, export competitiveness, and overall profitability during the conflict period.

3.1 Global Commodity Price Trend

The dual-line chart displaying Global Oil Price ($/bbl) and Global Wheat Price ($/MT) by fiscal year reveals a correlated commodity price shock beginning in FY 2022-23. The dashboard reports aggregate values:

- Sum of Global Oil Price ($/bbl): $17,612.71 — reflecting the sharp rise from ~$62/bbl pre-war to $88–125/bbl during Active War.
- Sum of Global Wheat Price ($/MT): Corresponding surge from ~$200/MT to over $300–420/MT during peak conflict period.
- By FY 2023-24 and 2024-25, oil prices moderated to $78–100/bbl as new supply routes were established, but remained substantially above pre-war levels.

3.2 INR/USD Exchange Rate vs Sanctions Severity

The combo chart on the dashboard overlays INR/USD exchange rate (bar) against Sanctions Severity Score (line) by fiscal year. This is one of the most analytically significant visualizations, demonstrating the direct correlation between geopolitical pressure and currency depreciation:

Fiscal Year	War Phase	Avg INR/USD Rate	Avg Sanctions Score (/10)	INR Direction
2019-20	Pre-War	~70.5	0.0 (None)	Stable
2020-21	Pre-War	~72.3	0.0 (None)	Mild depreciation
2021-22	Pre-War	~74.8	0.0 (None)	Creeping weakness
2022-23	Active War	~81.4	7.8 / 10	Sharp depreciation
2023-24	Active War	~83.2	8.5 / 10	Continued weakness
2024-25	Prolonged War	~85.1	8.9 / 10	Near record lows

The dashboard's Sum of INR/USD Exchange Rate figure of $16,624.48 confirms the cumulative currency pressure India experienced. As Western sanctions intensified — pushing the score toward 9.0/10 — the rupee weakened against the dollar, raising the effective import cost of energy and food commodities denominated in dollars. This created a compound inflationary pressure: rising global commodity prices combined with a weaker rupee.

3.3 Profitability Analysis

The dashboard reports an Avg Profit % (India) of 14.23% across all 216 records. This metric represents India's net trade profitability, accounting for the price differential between import costs and export revenues. Importantly, profitability actually improved during the Active War phase for two reasons:

- India secured Russian crude oil at a 20–30% discount to global market prices due to Western buyer sanctions, significantly reducing the effective cost of India's largest import category.
- Indian pharmaceutical and engineering goods exports to Russia faced reduced competition as Western suppliers withdrew, allowing Indian exporters to command better margins.
- The average monthly trade balance of ($488.54) Mn reflects the persistent but manageable nature of the deficit on a per-record basis.

4. Products & Exports — Page 3 Dashboard Analysis

The Products & Exports page provides granular visibility into the specific commodities driving trade flows in both directions. This page is critical for understanding India's export diversification strategy and the concentration risk in both import and export product portfolios.

4.1 India's Total Export Volume by Product

The horizontal bar chart ranks India's top exported products by total trade volume. From the dashboard data:

Rank	Exported Product (India)	Approx. Trade Volume	Key Destination	Growth Phase
1	Chemicals	Highest volume	Russia (dominant)	Active & Prolonged War
2	Pharmaceuticals	Very high	Russia & Ukraine	All phases
3	IT Services	High	Russia primarily	Stable across phases
4	Machinery Parts	Moderate-high	Russia	Rising Active War
5	Rice	Moderate	Ukraine primarily	Pre-War peak
6	Engineering Goods	Moderate	Both countries	Stable
7	Sugar	Moderate	Ukraine	Declining post-war
8	Textiles	Lower-moderate	Russia	Stable
9	Tea	Lower	Russia	Pre-War focus

Chemicals and Pharmaceuticals dominate India's export basket to both Russia and Ukraine. This reflects India's well-established position as the world's pharmacy, supplying generic medicines and chemical intermediates. During the Active War phase, Russia's isolation from Western pharmaceutical suppliers created a significant opportunity for Indian exporters to expand market share.

4.2 Top Import Products from Russia

The treemap/donut chart on the dashboard breaks down Russia's import product share by volume. The dashboard reveals 11 distinct product categories with the following distribution:

Product	Volume (USD Mn)	Share %	Category	War Phase Impact
LNG	39.36K	13.60%	Energy	Surged Active War
Natural Gas	32.80K	11.33%	Energy	Surged Active War
Crude Oil	31.22K	10.79%	Energy	Massive surge
Potash	27.65K	9.55%	Agriculture	Moderate growth
Fertilizers	26.61K	9.20%	Agriculture	Price spike
Petroleum Products	25.30K	8.74%	Energy	Rising
Coal	21.82K	7.54%	Energy	Increasing
Nitrogen Fertilizer	20.29K	7.01%	Agriculture	Stable

Product	Volume (USD Mn)	Share %	Category	War Phase Impact
Natural Gas (piped)	19.57K	6.76%	Energy	Rising
Steel	17.39K	6.01%	Industrial	Stable
Aluminum	16.50K	5.70%	Industrial	Moderate

Energy products (LNG, Natural Gas, Crude Oil, Petroleum Products, Coal) collectively dominate India's import basket from Russia, accounting for approximately 48% of total import value. This concentrated dependence on Russian energy represents both India's greatest opportunity (discounted pricing) and its greatest strategic risk (supply security). The fertilizer category (Potash, Nitrogen Fertilizer) is similarly significant as Russia is one of the world's largest fertilizer exporters, directly impacting India's agricultural sector input costs.

4.3 Profit % by Commodity Category and War Phase

The grouped bar chart on the dashboard compares Profit % across all three commodity categories by war phase. This is the dashboard's most strategically important visual:

War Phase	Energy Profit %	Agriculture Profit %	Industrial Profit %	Overall Trend
Pre-War	~10–12%	~9–11%	~10–12%	Uniform moderate profit
Active War	~16–20%	~13–16%	~14–18%	Energy & Industrial spike
Prolonged War	~17–21%	~14–18%	~15–19%	All categories elevated

The data confirms that India's profitability improved across all commodity categories during the war phases. The Energy sector shows the most dramatic improvement, as discounted Russian crude pricing reduced India's effective import cost, while Indian refiners could sell petroleum products on the global market at market rates — a significant margin arbitrage opportunity.

5. Data Records — Page 4 Dashboard Analysis

The Data Records page provides the granular transaction-level view of trade data, enabling drill-down analysis filtered by War Phase, Fiscal Year, Commodity Category, and Month. The table shows 216 individual records with conditional formatting applied to War Phase, Trade Balance, and Profit % columns.

5.1 Sample Data Records (Top Records by Import Value)

The following table reproduces a representative sample of records visible in the dashboard, sorted by Import from Ukraine (USD Mn) descending — reflecting the high pre-war agricultural import period:

Fiscal Year	Month	War Phase	Commodity	Import Russia ($Mn)	Import Ukraine ($Mn)	Exp Russia ($Mn)	Exp Ukraine ($Mn)
2021-22	September	Pre-War	Agriculture	$312.3	$347.7	$257.2	$141.5
2019-20	February	Pre-War	Agriculture	$300.3	$347.0	$278.6	$192.5
2019-20	October	Pre-War	Agriculture	$283.5	$346.8	$296.2	$51.2
2019-20	November	Pre-War	Agriculture	$379.9	$343.0	$112.0	$103.7
2020-21	May	Pre-War	Agriculture	$320.1	$341.4	$181.0	$171.2
2021-22	April	Pre-War	Agriculture	$318.2	$327.2	$297.7	$95.2
2020-21	March	Pre-War	Agriculture	$384.7	$306.0	$127.5	$81.8
2020-21	February	Pre-War	Agriculture	$275.4	$305.6	$382.1	$66.3

5.2 Data Records Grand Total

The dashboard's total row confirms the following aggregate values across all 216 records:

Metric	Total Value (USD Mn)	Notes
Sum of Import from Russia	$1,75,311.8	Dominant across all 6 fiscal years
Sum of Import from Ukraine	$21,689.3	Significant pre-war, collapsed post-2022
Sum of Export to Russia	$70,713.8	Strong India-Russia export relationship
Sum of Export to Ukraine	$20,763.1	Moderate, reduced post-conflict
Net Trade Balance	($1,05,524.2)	Persistent deficit — import-heavy profile

6. Strategic Insights & Findings

6.1 India's Strategic Neutrality as a Trade Advantage

India's decision to maintain diplomatic neutrality in the Russia-Ukraine conflict translated into a concrete economic advantage. By refusing to join Western sanctions against Russia, India gained access to deeply discounted Russian energy at a time when European buyers were scrambling for alternative supplies. This neutrality also allowed India to continue exporting pharmaceuticals, chemicals, and IT services to Russia — markets that Western competitors vacated.

6.2 Energy Dependency Risk

While the discounted Russian crude opportunity has been financially beneficial, the dashboard data reveals a concentration risk that warrants strategic attention. Energy imports from Russia now represent the largest single driver of India's trade deficit. This dependency on a single supplier for a critical strategic commodity exposes India to supply disruption risk, geopolitical leverage, and potential secondary sanctions pressure from Western economies.

6.3 Agricultural Supply Chain Vulnerability

The collapse in Ukrainian agricultural imports — particularly wheat, corn, and sunflower oil — highlights India's vulnerability to agricultural supply shocks. Ukraine and Russia together account for approximately 30% of global wheat exports and 80% of sunflower oil. The disruption contributed to global food price inflation that impacted India's own domestic food cost basket, even as India itself is a major food exporter.

6.4 Export Opportunity Realised

India's pharmaceutical and chemical sectors demonstrated remarkable agility in capturing market share vacated by Western suppliers in Russia. The dashboard's product analysis confirms that Chemicals and Pharmaceuticals are India's top two export categories by volume, indicating that Indian industry successfully scaled up to meet Russia's diversified import requirements during the sanctions period.

6.5 Currency & Inflation Pressure

The strong correlation between sanctions severity and INR/USD depreciation, visible in the Economic Impact dashboard page, highlights that India was not immune to the macroeconomic spillover effects of the conflict. A weaker rupee raised the effective cost of dollar-denominated imports, partially offsetting the price discount gains on Russian crude oil.

7. Recommendations

7.1 Diversify Energy Import Sources

- Accelerate investment in Middle Eastern and African energy supply agreements to reduce concentration risk on Russian sources.
- Increase strategic petroleum reserves to buffer against potential supply disruption scenarios.
- Expand renewable energy capacity to reduce the overall import dependency on fossil fuels.

7.2 Strengthen Agricultural Trade Corridors

- Negotiate alternative agricultural supply agreements with Brazil, Argentina, and Australia to replace Ukrainian supply capacity.
- Invest in domestic agricultural storage and processing infrastructure to reduce price volatility from external supply shocks.

7.3 Capitalise on Russia Export Opportunity

- Support Indian pharmaceutical and engineering exporters with export credit and insurance facilities to scale up Russia market presence.
- Negotiate long-term supply agreements in pharmaceuticals and IT services that lock in market share for post-conflict trade normalisation.

7.4 Monitor Secondary Sanctions Risk

- Establish a real-time sanctions monitoring framework to ensure Indian trading entities remain compliant with evolving Western secondary sanctions regimes.
- Maintain payments infrastructure diversity — explore Rupee-Ruble settlement mechanisms as a hedge against SWIFT system risks.

8. Conclusion

The Russia-Ukraine conflict has fundamentally reshaped India's bilateral trade landscape with both countries. The Power BI dashboard analysis across 216 records, six fiscal years, three commodity categories, and three geopolitical phases reveals a nuanced picture: India has been a net beneficiary of the energy discount opportunity created by Western sanctions, while simultaneously bearing the costs of agricultural supply disruption, currency depreciation, and widening trade deficits.

With a cumulative trade deficit of $1,05,524.2 Mn and an average profitability of 14.23% — notably higher than pre-war levels — India's trade strategy during the conflict has been commercially rational even if strategically complex. The challenge ahead is converting this short-term opportunity into long-term trade diversification that reduces dependency on any single supplier or commodity corridor.

The dashboard's data architecture — spanning trade volumes, commodity categories, price indices, exchange rates, and sanctions scores — provides a robust analytical foundation for ongoing trade policy monitoring. Future dashboard versions should incorporate quarterly updates as the geopolitical situation continues to evolve.

Prepared by: Trade Analytics Division | Source: Power BI Dashboard — Russia-Ukraine-India Trade Dataset | Date: March 2026